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VOL. 15 · CARRIACOU AND PETITE MARTINIQUE

Every Polling Station: The Sister Isles After Beryl

Hurricane Beryl flattened Carriacou and Petite Martinique in July 2024. Two years later the sister isles re-elected the NDC's Tevin Andrews by 976 votes over the NNP's deputy leader, who carried a single polling division, in his own home village.

BY GREG HOSTEN

CARRIACOU AND PETITE MARTINIQUE, GRENADA

CARRIACOU AND PETITE MARTINIQUE, GRENADA—On 1st July 2024 Hurricane Beryl made landfall on Carriacou as a Category 4 storm. The Attorney General reported that 95 per cent of homes on Carriacou and Petite Martinique had been damaged or destroyed, and for the next two years recovery was the only issue that mattered on the sister isles.

> **"Voters on the sister isles judged the recovery by what they saw."**
> GREG HOSTEN

On 5th November the voters delivered their verdict on that recovery. The NDC's Tevin Andrews, the sitting member and the party's chairman, took 2,392 votes to 1,416 for Norland Cox, the NNP's deputy political leader. In 2022 Mr. Andrews had won by 149; this time he won by 976.

A SEAT THE NNP HELD FOR A GENERATION

The NNP's Elvin Nimrod represented Carriacou and Petite Martinique from 1999, through the party's 2008 defeat, until he retired before the 2018 election. Kindra Maturine-Stewart held the seat for the NNP in 2018, then lost it to Mr. Andrews in 2022 by 1,954 votes to 1,805.

A 149-vote defeat should have marked the start of a comeback. Instead the NNP named a new caretaker only in September 2025, 14 months before polling day, and chose its deputy leader, Mr. Cox, who had been the party's losing candidate in St. George South in 2022.

THE SECOND SEAT FOR THE SAME CANDIDATE

Mr. Cox was born in Dover, Carriacou, and served for years as a public officer in the Ministry of Carriacou and Petite Martinique Affairs before entering politics. He is a former Minister of Infrastructure and served as Deputy President of the Senate after 2022. His roots on the island are genuine.

Voters had nonetheless watched him stand in St. George South in 2022 and lose there by 1,068, and his return to Carriacou in 2025 as a candidate for a different seat invited an obvious question about commitment. As our St. George South volume observed, the party moved its 2022 candidate to a different seat and lost both.

THE RECOVERY ELECTION

After Beryl, the government in St. George's controlled the money, the materials and the visible work of rebuilding, and Mr. Andrews, as the sitting member and NDC chairman, was the local face of that effort. In Parliament, Mr. Cox criticised what he called disaster-driven reconstruction spending, financed by passport sales and borrowing.

The result suggests that voters on the sister isles judged the recovery by what they saw, and gave the government the credit. Mr. Andrews's vote rose by 438 while the NNP's fell by 389, and the NNP's share of the two-party vote fell from 48.0 per cent to 37.2 per cent, a drop of 10.8 points, slightly more than the national swing.

ONE DIVISION, IN DOVER

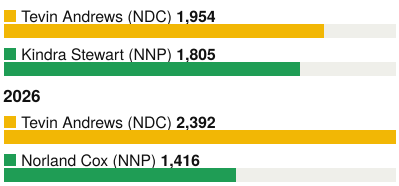
The polling-division returns are striking. The NNP carried just 1 of the 18 divisions: one of the two at the Dover Government School, in Mr. Cox's home village, by 74 votes to 69. It lost the other Dover division by 105 to 46.

Its next-best results came at the Windward Medical Station, where it lost by 136 to 123, and at L'Esterre, where it took 43.1 per cent across three divisions. Petite Martinique, the island hardest hit by Beryl, gave the NNP 38.3 per cent across two divisions.

Hillsborough, the main town, went heavily to the NDC. At the Hillsborough Government

2022 VS 2026

Votes by candidate, in party colours



976 votes
NDC winning margin in 2026

BY THE NUMBERS

976
NDC winning margin, up from 149 in 2022

1 of 18
Polling divisions won by the NNP, in Dover

95%
Homes damaged or destroyed by Beryl, July 2024

–389
Fall in the NNP vote since 2022

School the NNP took 20.3 per cent across two divisions, and in one of them just 30 votes to 174; at Mount Pleasant it took 24.6 per cent, and at Bogles 28.8 per cent.

TURNOUT AND THE REGISTER

The register grew by 596 names and 45 more ballots were cast, while turnout fell from 69.8 per cent to 63.6 per cent and 2,185 registered voters did not vote. The NDC's share of the whole electorate rose from 36.1 to 39.8 per cent; the NNP's fell from 33.3 to 23.6 per cent.

Part of the fall in turnout may reflect residents still displaced after Beryl. The shift between the parties, however, is unmistakable, and it ran towards the government that led the rebuilding.

FOUR HUNDRED AND EIGHTY-NINE VOTERS

To win the seat back, the NNP needs 489 voters to switch sides, or 977 more of its own supporters to turn out, about 45 per cent of those who stayed home. Recovering the 2022 vote of 1,805 alone would cut the margin by 40 per cent.

Carriacou and Petite Martinique has a long NNP history and was lost by only 149 votes four years ago. It is winnable, but only by a party that commits to the islands as a constituency in their own right.

WHAT CAN BE DONE: A FOUR-YEAR PLAN FOR THE SISTER ISLES

Carriacou and Petite Martinique needs an NNP that lives on the islands, not one that visits them.

Year one, 2027: decide the candidate early, from the islands, and commit to that person for two elections. Whether Mr. Cox remains or a successor is chosen, the candidate should live on Carriacou or Petite Martinique and keep an office in Hillsborough open throughout the term.

Year two, 2028: conduct a public review of the Beryl recovery, island by island and village by village, setting out which homes have been rebuilt and which have not, what was promised and what was delivered, and publish it. That is the issue voters will judge in 2030/31, and the opposition should know it better than the government does.

Year three, 2029: recruit a captain for each of the 18 polling divisions, including both on Petite Martinique, and build from Dover, Windward and L'Esterre into Hillsborough, Bogles and Mount Pleasant.

Year four, 2030: target 489 switchers, beginning with the 389 NNP voters lost since 2022.

THE LESSON FOR THE WHOLE SERIES

Fifteen seats yield fifteen stories, and the same lessons recur throughout. Candidates named early and kept in place hold up better; long-serving members need planned, public successions; parties that keep their elected members keep their seats; and the four years after an election decide the next one far more than the four weeks before it.

The NNP won one seat in 2026, and the method that held St. George North West is no secret. The question for 2030/31 is whether the party will apply it everywhere, beginning now.

THE ARITHMETIC OF CARRIACOU AND PETITE MARTINIQUE

Measure	2022	2026	Change
NNP votes	1,805	1,416	−389
NDC votes	1,954	2,392	+438
NNP share of two-party vote	48.0%	37.2%	−10.8 pts
NNP two-party share nationally	48.0%	37.7%	−10.3 pts
Winning margin	NDC +149	NDC +976	
Registered voters	5,414	6,010	+596
Turnout	69.8%	63.6%	−6.2 pts
Registered voters who did not vote	1,634	2,185	+551
NNP votes as a share of all registered voters	33.3%	23.6%	−9.7 pts
Polling divisions won by the NNP		1 of 18	
Switchers the NNP needed to win		489	

Straight two-party contest in 2026. 2026 figures are provisional results from the Parliamentary Elections Office, all 18 polling divisions verified.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR 2030/31

1. Choose a candidate who lives on the islands and keep them there.
2. Do not move candidates between seats: it lost both in this case.
3. Name the caretaker early: 14 months was not enough after a 149-vote loss.
4. Own the Beryl recovery record better than the government does.
5. Keep an office open in Hillsborough throughout the term.
6. Build from Dover, Windward and L'Esterre into Hillsborough.
7. Captain all 18 divisions, including Petite Martinique.
8. Target 489 switchers, starting with the 389 votes lost since 2022.

Sources: Parliamentary Elections Office live results, live.elections.gd (2026, provisional; polling divisions read 9 Nov 2026); Wikipedia (2008 and 2022 general elections); NOW Grenada (Nimrod retirement and caretaker, May 2017; Cox named caretaker, 16 Sep 2025; Cox on the 2026 Budget; Deputy President of the Senate, Oct 2022; 2026 results); The New Today (Cox profile); The Watchers / ReliefWeb (Hurricane Beryl damage, Jul 2024). Analytics computed by the author from the published counts. Analysis by Greg Hosten, Vol. 15 of a weekly constituency series. Written in the style of a newspaper report; not a publication of any news organisation.